ADRIAN CIOANCA

PhD | Data & AI Consultant | Biotech Co-founder | **NV1 Security Clearance**

adrian.v.cioanca@gmail.com | 0450 399 725 | Canberra, Australia | linkedin.com/in/adrian-c-58743b25a | Google Scholar

PROFILE

Applying for the Associate role via the Advanced Professional Degree pathway. Most APD hires bring PhD-level rigour straight from the bench; this candidacy adds a biotech asset built, valued and sold under commercial pressure, and client delivery at Accenture already tested against real clients rather than assumed from academic potential alone. The throughline across both: taking an ambiguous, high-stakes problem through to a decision someone senior has to act on.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Accenture | Strategy & Consulting, Data & AI | Consultant / Team Lead — Jan 2026 – Present

- Led a 3-person data engineering team to diagnose a national energy retailer's regulatory compliance bottleneck, then architected an automated analytics solution that assessed business activities against regulatory requirements; applied research-informed NLP and retrieval techniques to cut clause identification from days to minutes.
- Built an internal Defence market-intelligence platform using React, FastAPI and AI agents over AusTender, ministerial releases and competitor activity; reduced opportunity research from hours to minutes and now feeds market sizing for live bids.
- Took ownership of a Defence client's proof-of-concept data pipeline in a secure, air-gapped cloud environment, designing the technical approach end to end from requirements through to a validated proof of concept; demonstrated that the team could deliver production-grade data products under air-gapped constraints.

ErythroSIGHT | Co-founder & CTO — 2023 – Present

- Built the valuation and market case for a preclinical asset using discounted-cash-flow and risk-adjusted NPV models, prevalence and pricing; co-developed investor materials and pitched at 3 national accelerators, raising **$670K** in non-dilutive funding and winning CSIRO ON Accelerate (<5% acceptance).
- Set the scientific strategy for ErythroSIGHT's lead therapeutic: selected the candidate, built the R&D pipeline through pre-clinical and toxicology testing while managing CRO, patent-attorney and regulatory partnerships, and generated the resulting intellectual property, securing **3** national patents and commercialising the technology through licensing.

Australian National University | Postdoctoral Researcher, John Curtin School of Medical Research — 2022 – 2026

- Worked as an embedded technical consultant for industry partners, securing a **$300K** engagement with Beta Therapeutics and delivering a **$200K** end-to-end preclinical model for Merck & Co.: led prototyping, managed fabrication and delivered end-user training; cut time to results from 3 months to 2 weeks and returned **8x** the build cost, with Merck moving the work in-house on completion.
- Led a 7-person team across 20 research groups at 7 universities developing RNA therapeutics for retinal degeneration; reached 25 papers (9 lead-author), ranked 3rd nationally in the field, and secured **$514K** in competitive funding.
- Earned promotion to Level B in 1.5 years versus a typical 4–5 year progression, demonstrating sustained performance in research leadership and delivery.

EDUCATION

Australian National University | PhD, Neuroscience & Bioinformatics — 2018 – 2022

- **Frank Fenner Medal** for best PhD at the John Curtin School of Medical Research (1 of 103); J.G. Crawford Prize nominee for best thesis at ANU.
- Australian Postgraduate Award ($112K, top 5%); 4 competitive research grants ($97K; 5–10% success rates); elected ANU representative to the Global Young Scientists Summit.

University of New South Wales | BSc Advanced Science, First Class Honours — 2013 – 2017

- Top honours thesis mark; 2 research scholarships awarded to the top 10% of the faculty.

LEADERSHIP & ADDITIONAL

- **Teaching & leadership:** Sole genetics lecturer, ANU Medical School (4.8/5 average across 87 evaluations); founded Vision ACTion, connecting clinicians, researchers and patients.
- Led 5-person team to 2nd of 10 at InnovFest Singapore, pitching to Westpac and Singtel; recognised for delivery/community contribution by 3 Accenture Managing Directors.
- Developed pitch decks and solution materials for senior managers supporting Accenture contract bids; built an internal AI agent helping early-career recruits find their best-fit service line.

CAPABILITIES

Analytical: Statistical modelling, machine learning, Python, R, SQL | **Commercial:** Financial modelling, valuation, market sizing, competitor analysis, IP strategy